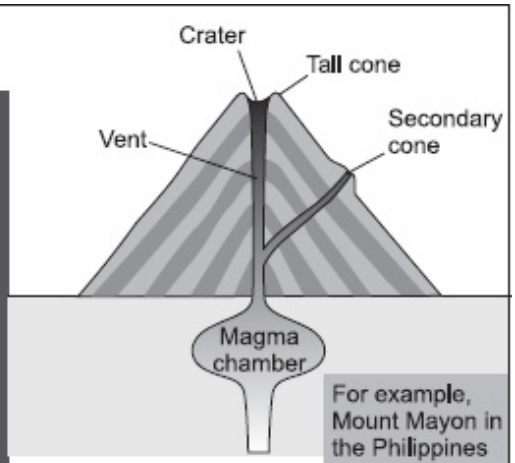
Volcanoes

There are two main types of volcanoes.

Composite Volcanoes

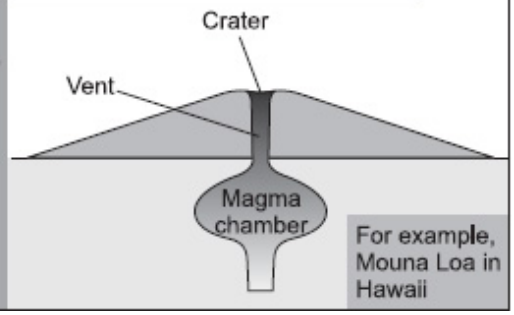
- They are found at destructive plate margins. When the oceanic plate into the mantle and melts, it forms magma. Magma mixed with sea water then rises up through cracks in the Earth's crust and erupts at the surface – forming volcanoes.
- Composite volcanoes have steep sides, and are made up of alternate layers of ash and lava.
- Since the lava is sticky, it does not flow far. It is also acidic.
- Eruptions can be violent-expelling steam, ash, lava and rock but they do not happen very often.



For example, Mount Mayon in the Philippines

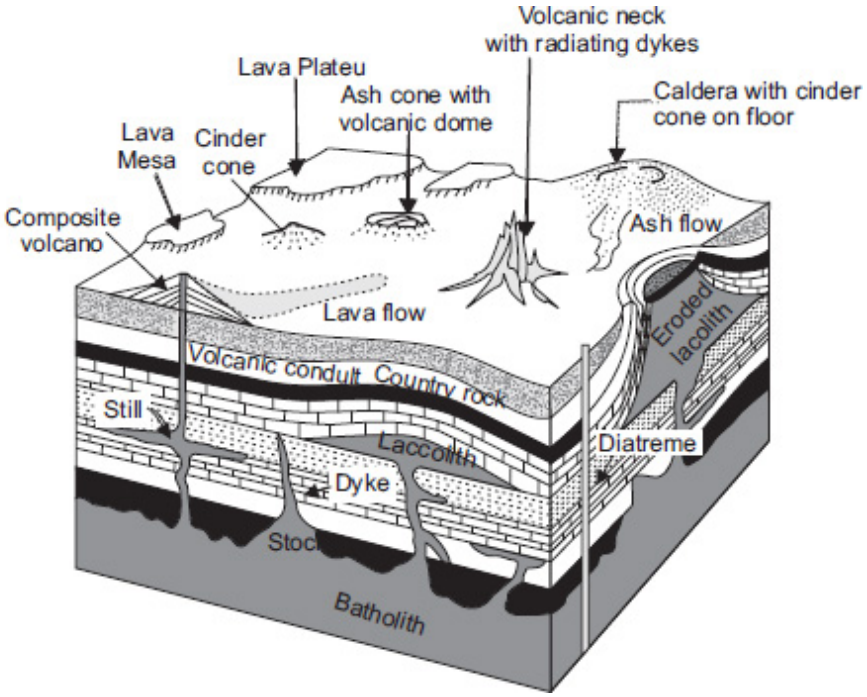
Shield volcanoes

- They are found at constructive plate margins. As the two plates move apart, magma rises up from the mantle. Some magma is forced to the surface through a vent – forming a valcano.
- Shield volcanoes have a wide base and gently sloping sides.
- The lava is runny and flows a long way. It is also basic (which is the opposite of acidic).
- There can be frequent eruptions, but they are not violent.



For example, Mouna Loa in Hawaii

83.



84. Earth's major earthquakes occur mainly in belts coinciding with the margins of tectonic plates.